

HYPERTENSION (SCREENING AND PEC AT CDS)

1. Definition hypertension :

Essential hypertension in adults is defined as systolic blood pressure greater than or equal to 14 cmHg and diastolic blood pressure greater than or equal to 9 cmHg. The rise in BP must be permanent: measured twice at rest during consultations. Three major risks for the patient: stroke, heart failure and kidney failure. **Pregnancy-induced hypertension** is defined as a blood pressure (BP) greater than or equal to 14 cmHg systolic, or greater than or equal to 9 cmHg diastolic (patient at rest and seated). It may be isolated or associated with proteinuria or oedema in the case of pre-eclampsia. It exposes the patient to the risk eclampsia, retroplacental hematoma and premature delivery.

2. Circumstances of discovery :

- Some symptoms point hypertension: headaches, dizziness, ringing in the ears, epistaxis, heart palpitations, confusion, but are not specific.
- **In most cases**, it is discovered during a examination.
- **Sometimes** revealed by a major complication: heart failure, kidney failure, stroke.

3. Case management

a) Treatment goals for hypertension

Patients must be informed that treatment is for life, and that interrupting treatment is dangerous.

- Bring BP back to normal, i.e. below 14 cmHg of pressure systolic and 9 cmHg diastolic
- In case of associated diabetes, BP < 13/8 cmHg and if proteinuria BP < 12.5 / 7.5 cmHg
- Prevent complications hypertension ;
- Managing modifiable cardiovascular risk factors

b) Hygienic-dietary measures to modify lifestyle habits :

i. **Rest and a low-salt diet** (<6g/24h NaCl) avoiding salty foods and foods rich in salt (cold meats, bread). A strict salt-free diet will only be prescribed in cases of associated heart failure.

ii. **Weight reduction** case of overweight (if BMI > 25 Kg/m²)

It lowers blood pressure and has a beneficial effect diabetes, insulin resistance and dyslipidemia.

iii. **Reasonably increase physical activity**

It's better to do sport several times a week than just once for a long time (30 minutes 3 times a week).

c) Treatments

Nifedipine 20mg: 3x 1cp/d, or Hydrochlorothiazide 25mg/d

except in pregnant women, where Methyldopa 250mg is used: 3x 1cp/d